CORSA x HSG Capstone Project

International Execution Blueprint for CORSA Jakarta

Prepared for

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1. Project Context

CORSA is a next-generation food and lifestyle brand born in Zurich, designed for people who move. The brand combines Italian heritage, modern performance culture, healthy Mediterranean food, specialty coffee, functional drinks and community into one scalable system. The core idea is not to build “just another café”, but to implement a global lifestyle food brand with strong identity, commercial discipline and cultural relevance.

The first CORSA pop-up at Zurich HB validated the concept in one of Switzerland’s most competitive and high-frequency locations. The brand achieved strong customer traction, including over 200,000 people reached, a 4.9-star Google rating and positive operational proof after a three-month pop-up phase. The concept has already been executed in a real market environment, with real customers, real products, real team structures and real operational learnings.

The next strategic step is the first international flagship location in Jakarta, Indonesia. The decision for Jakarta is not purely emotional. It is based on the market’s scale, its growing middle class, its young and urban population, high eating frequency, strong café culture, rising fitness and lifestyle communities, and its potential to become a powerful gateway for CORSA’s international positioning. The existing Jakarta concept already defines the city as a market with young, urban and social consumers, increasing café culture and rising interest in fitness, performance and community-driven lifestyle brands.

The Capstone Project should therefore not be understood as a theoretical “Go / No-Go” analysis. Jakarta is the selected direction. The project should be treated as an execution-oriented strategy and business case project for a functioning start-up brand preparing its next fixed location and first international flagship.

2. Strategic Intention

The main objective of the Capstone Project is to further develop a realistic and execution-ready international expansion blueprint for CORSA Jakarta.

The students should help CORSA answer one central question:

How can CORSA successfully enter Jakarta as its first international flagship location — commercially, culturally, operationally and brand-wise?

This includes market validation, location logic, financial modelling, brand transfer, local adaptation, community building, ambassador strategy, investor narrative and execution planning.

The project should not aim to confirm assumptions. Instead, it should challenge, test and improve them. The entrepreneurial mindset behind the project is:

Test assumptions. Learn fast. Adapt. Overcome. Execute.

The final output should be valuable first and foremost for CORSA itself. If the work is strong enough internally, it can then also serve as a foundation for discussions with HSG, investors, local Jakarta partners, ambassadors, potential brokers, community leaders and strategic brand partners.

The two most important success dimensions are:

1. **Profitability / Net Profit Potential**
2. **Brand Establishment / Cultural Relevance**

Growth, commercial strength and brand identity must be treated together. CORSA should not become a beautiful but unprofitable concept, nor a profitable but soulless chain. The project must balance both.

3. Why HSG Students Are a Good Fit

The Capstone Project takes place towards the end of the Bachelor studies in Business Administration at HSG. According to HSG's Bachelor curriculum, students have already covered broad foundations in business administration, including marketing, strategic management, corporate finance, accounting, controlling and auditing. HSG also lists entrepreneurship, marketing, leadership and human resource management as part of the Bachelor curriculum, and positions the Capstone Project as a practical project in which students apply acquired knowledge. (HSG - Uni SG)

During the HSG Assessment Year, students are also exposed to strategy, digital transformation, marketing, production and supply chain management, as well as teamwork, case study analysis and written group work through the integrative project. (HSG - Uni SG)

This makes the HSG students well-suited for a project that requires structured thinking, market analysis, financial logic, business model evaluation, strategic communication and entrepreneurial judgement.

At the same time, it is important to acknowledge that the students will likely have different profiles. Some may have completed internships and gained practical experience, while others may be more academically or theoretically oriented. For that reason, CORSA proposes a short diagnostic and orientation phase at the start of the project to understand the students' strengths, working styles and entrepreneurial mindset.

4. Project Philosophy

CORSA is not looking for a classical consulting-style document that only describes the market from a distance. The project should be close to reality and close to execution.

The students should be encouraged to work like early-stage operators:

They should research, structure, calculate, challenge, compare, prioritize and prepare real next steps.

They should not protect the initial idea. They should improve it.

They should not only create beautiful slides. They should create a usable decision and execution basis.

They should not only look for positive confirmation. They should identify risks, weaknesses and blind spots, then propose practical responses.

The attitude behind the project is entrepreneurial:

Assumptions are not facts.
Markets must be understood.
Numbers must be tested.
Brand must be protected.
Execution must be fast.
Adaptability is survival.

5. Week 0: Founder Challenge & Team Diagnostic

Before the main workstreams begin, CORSA proposes a short starting challenge.

Purpose

The aim is to understand how the students think, how they deal with uncertainty and which roles they may naturally take within the project.

This is not meant as a formal personality test. It is meant as a founder-style diagnostic exercise.

Challenge

“In 72 hours, explain why CORSA can win in Jakarta — and why it could fail.”

Expected Output

Each student prepares:

- 3–5 slides
- One clear core thesis
- One serious counter-thesis
- At least five sources
- One surprising number or insight
- One concrete recommendation
- A short reflection on the role each student could best play in the project

What CORSA Wants to Learn

This phase should help identify:

- Who thinks strategically?
- Who is strong analytically?
- Who is commercially minded?
- Who understands brand and culture?
- Who can work with numbers?
- Who can simplify complexity?
- Who is comfortable challenging assumptions?
- Who has execution energy?

After this first diagnostic phase, the group can be divided into workstreams based on strengths and interests.

6. Core Project Workstreams

The project should be structured into six major workstreams.

Workstream 1: Jakarta Market & Consumer Reality

Objective

Understand Jakarta as a real market for CORSA — not only from a macro perspective, but from the perspective of actual consumers, daily behaviour, food culture and lifestyle habits.

Key Questions

- Who are the most relevant CORSA customers in Jakarta?
- How strong is the demand for premium lifestyle cafés, healthy pasta, specialty coffee and functional drinks?
- How do young professionals, students, creatives, fitness communities and upper-middle-class consumers eat, drink and socialize?
- What is the local willingness to pay?
- How important are cafés as social spaces in Jakarta?
- How does Jakarta compare to Singapore, Dubai and Hong Kong?
- What makes Jakarta more attractive or more risky than these alternative international markets?

Areas to Analyse

- Young urban professionals
- Upper-middle-class consumers
- Students
- Fitness and running communities
- Creators and lifestyle audiences
- Expats
- Nightlife and afterhours consumers
- Premium mall and street culture
- Food delivery behaviour
- Café culture
- Healthy food and functional nutrition trends

Expected Output

- Jakarta market overview
- Target customer profiles
- Consumer behaviour map
- Competitor landscape
- Comparison with Singapore, Dubai and Hong Kong
- Key opportunities and risks
- Clear conclusion on why Jakarta is the right next step and what needs to be adapted

Workstream 2: Location Strategy & Real Estate Logic

Objective

Build a clear location strategy for CORSA Jakarta.

The existing Jakarta concept identifies SCBD, Senopati and Kuningan as Tier 1 areas, with Kemang and PIK as Tier 2 areas. The ideal location is defined as a flagship store of approximately 120–180 sqm, ground floor, strong street visibility and a combination of sit-down and take-away.

Key Questions

- Which areas in Jakarta best match CORSA's target audience?
- Which areas have the highest lifestyle and brand fit?
- Which areas offer the best balance between visibility, rent, customer profile and long-term brand value?
- Should CORSA prioritize street visibility, mall traffic, community proximity or nightlife energy?
- What kind of location would support both daytime café use and evening "Night Pit Stop" positioning?

Areas to Evaluate

Tier 1:

- SCBD
- Senopati
- Kuningan

Tier 2:

- Kemang
- PIK

Potential comparison areas may be added by the students.

Evaluation Criteria

- Target group fit
- Footfall and frequency
- Visibility
- Accessibility
- Nearby offices / gyms / universities / lifestyle hubs
- Rent level
- Brand environment

- Competitor density
- Social media potential
- Daytime and night-time usability
- Operational feasibility
- Investor attractiveness

Expected Output

- Location scorecard
- Area comparison
- Ideal location profile
- Top 5 recommended micro-locations
- Broker / landlord / local partner contact map prepared for later outreach
- Clear recommendation for first location search

Workstream 3: Jakarta Financial Model & Business Case

Objective

Develop a realistic Jakarta-specific financial model.

The current investment assumption is approximately **CHF 250,000** for the first Jakarta flagship. This number must be validated, challenged and broken down into realistic cost blocks.

The existing CORSA financial thinking already includes multi-layer revenue logic, including store revenue, online sales, partnerships, community and events. The Zurich pop-up numbers, product performance, cost structure, learnings and operational KPIs can be shared transparently with the students.

Key Questions

- What is the realistic investment requirement for Jakarta?
- Is CHF 250,000 sufficient?
- What are the expected CAPEX and OPEX levels?
- What daily revenue is needed to break even?
- What is the expected payback period?
- What pricing strategy makes sense in Jakarta?
- What gross margin can be expected for pasta, coffee, drinks and add-ons?
- What staff structure is needed?
- What is the realistic best / base / worst case?

Required Model Components

CAPEX:

- Build-out
- Kitchen equipment
- Coffee equipment
- Interior and furniture
- Branding and signage
- POS / tech systems
- Pre-opening marketing
- Legal setup
- Licenses
- Training
- Working capital

OPEX:

- Rent
- Staff
- Food cost
- Packaging
- Utilities
- Marketing
- Maintenance
- Accounting / admin
- Local management
- Delivery platform fees if relevant
- Miscellaneous operating costs

Revenue:

- Pasta
- Coffee
- Functional drinks
- Breakfast / snacks
- Add-ons
- Retail products
- Events
- B2B partnerships
- Future merchandise

Scenarios:

- Conservative case
- Base case
- Aggressive case

Expected Output

- Jakarta-specific financial model
- Break-even calculation
- Investment need
- Payback logic
- Unit economics
- Daily sales targets
- Sensitivity analysis
- Investor-facing financial summary

Workstream 4: Brand Transfer & Product Adaptation

Objective

Define what must remain globally consistent and what must be locally adapted for Jakarta.

CORSA must protect its identity. At the same time, the concept must feel relevant to Jakarta.

The existing Jakarta concept already defines that the core remains pasta, coffee, functional drinks and community, while the Jakarta adaptation may require more social space, a stronger night layer, content-driven activation and local integration.

Core Brand Elements to Preserve

- Italian heritage
- Performance culture
- Healthy Mediterranean food
- Specialty coffee
- Functional drinks
- Community
- Content engine
- Strong visual identity
- Racing / Formula 1-inspired energy
- “Fuel for people who move”
- “Race. Drink. Eat. Repeat.”
- Premium but accessible lifestyle positioning

Jakarta Adaptation Questions

- How should the food offering adapt to local taste without losing the Italian Mediterranean core?
- How strong should the healthy angle be: low carb, high protein, gluten-free pasta, clean energy?

- What should the price architecture look like?
- Should the location operate more as a café, restaurant, community hub or hybrid?
- How important is the night layer?
- What kind of store design would work in Jakarta?
- What language, tone and visual cues should be used?
- How can CORSA become aspirational without becoming disconnected from local culture?

Expected Output

- Brand transfer framework
- Product adaptation logic
- Jakarta menu architecture
- Pricing logic
- Store experience concept
- Daytime / evening / community use-case definition
- Clear “global vs. local” decision framework

Workstream 5: Community, Ambassadors & CORSA GP Layer

Objective

Develop the community engine for Jakarta.

CORSA should not grow only through a location. It should grow through people, identity, movement, ambassadors and repeatable community formats.

The CORSA GP concept is a Formula 1-inspired running race that connects community, competition and sponsors. It is designed as a unique night event focused on team spirit, innovation and emotion. The concept also includes clear goals such as community building, creating a sponsor platform, establishing an innovative running format, building a recurring signature event and strengthening the emotional connection between sport, lifestyle and the CORSA brand.

For the Capstone Project, CORSA GP does not need to be fully executed within three months. However, the students should understand it as the next community layer and as a strategic growth engine.

Key Questions

- Which ambassador profiles are relevant in Jakarta?
- Which creators, actors, athletes, runners, lifestyle figures or entrepreneurs could credibly represent CORSA?

- Which communities matter before launch?
- Which gyms, running clubs, universities, fashion communities, coffee communities or lifestyle groups should be mapped?
- How can CORSA build local trust before opening?
- How can CORSA GP become a Year 1 or Year 2 activation in Jakarta?
- What sponsorship logic would fit the brand?

Existing Contact Base

CORSA already has access to certain families, two investors and well-known actors in Jakarta. Real estate and gastronomy entrepreneurs are not yet directly secured, but network access can be requested and activated once the strategic workstreams have clarified the right direction.

Expected Output

- Ambassador profile framework
- Community map
- Pre-launch activation concept
- Partner and sponsor logic
- CORSA GP Jakarta layer
- Contact database structure for later outreach
- Recommendations for who to approach first and why

Workstream 6: Investor Narrative & Execution Roadmap

Objective

Create the story and execution plan needed to convince CORSA internally first — and then investors, local partners and strategic stakeholders.

The final result should help CORSA prove the business case to itself first. Only then can it be communicated externally.

Key Questions

- Why CORSA?
- Why Jakarta?
- Why now?
- Why this team?
- Why is the model scalable?
- Why can CORSA compete with existing cafés, restaurants and lifestyle brands?
- What should investors believe?
- What could make the project fail?

- What are the next 90 days after the Capstone Project?

Oakberry Benchmark

Oakberry should be used as a relevant case study and growth reference.

The goal is not to copy Oakberry blindly. The goal is to understand the underlying expansion logic:

- Simple scalable product system
- Strong visual brand
- Health / performance positioning
- International lifestyle appeal
- Repeatable store model
- Franchise / investor logic
- Fast growth mindset
- Clear product hero
- Strong social media compatibility

The students should also analyse what CORSA can learn from Oakberry's weaknesses or risks, such as over-expansion, operational inconsistency, brand dilution or dependency on one hero product.

Expected Output

- Investor narrative
- Expansion story
- Strategic positioning deck
- Execution roadmap
- 90-day post-project action plan
- Jakarta travel preparation
- Meeting logic for investors, partners, brokers, ambassadors and community leaders

7. Expected Final Deliverables

By mid-December, the students should deliver a complete strategy and execution package.

Final Deliverables

1. **International Expansion Strategy Paper**
   A written strategic document explaining the Jakarta opportunity, assumptions, risks, business case and recommended execution path.
2. **Investor-Ready Expansion Deck**
   A clear presentation that can be adapted for investors, Jakarta partners and strategic stakeholders.

3. **Jakarta Financial Model**
   Excel / Google Sheets model with CAPEX, OPEX, revenue assumptions, margins, break-even, payback and scenarios.
4. **Location Scorecard**
   Evaluation of Jakarta districts and micro-locations with clear ranking and recommendation.
5. **Competitor & Benchmark Map**
   Jakarta competitors plus international references such as Oakberry, premium cafés, healthy food brands and community-led food concepts.
6. **Brand Transfer & Product Adaptation Framework**
   Definition of what remains global and what adapts locally.
7. **Ambassador & Community Playbook**
   Profiles, target communities, activation ideas and contact categories.
8. **Outreach Preparation Database**
   Structured list of relevant brokers, investors, brands, communities, ambassadors, creators and local partners. The students do not need to send outreach themselves, but they should prepare the structure and logic.
9. **90-Day Execution Plan**
   Concrete steps for January to March after the Capstone Project.

8. Suggested Project Timeline

Early September

Kick-off, introduction to CORSA, Zurich pop-up learnings, Jakarta vision, project expectations.

Week 0

Founder Challenge & Team Diagnostic.

September

Market analysis, competitor research, target customer profiles, benchmark analysis.

October

Location strategy, financial model draft, product and brand adaptation.

November

Community, ambassador and investor narrative; refinement of business case; preparation of contact database.

Early December

Final synthesis, strategy paper, expansion deck, financial model and execution roadmap.

Mid-December

Final presentation and handover.

9. Working Principles

The project should follow these principles:

Reality Over Theory

All work should be connected to real market behaviour, real numbers and real execution constraints.

Speed With Depth

The work should move fast, but not superficially. Every assumption must be supported by logic, data or clear reasoning.

Challenge the Founder

The students should not simply agree with CORSA's assumptions. They should challenge them constructively.

Protect the Brand

Growth must not dilute CORSA's identity.

Profit Matters

A beautiful brand without a profitable business case is not enough.

Adaptability Wins

The project must stay flexible. If the market shows that assumptions need to change, the strategy must change.

Execution Focus

The final result should enable action, not just discussion.

10. Success Definition

The project is successful if CORSA can say by mid-December:

- We understand the Jakarta market better.
- We know where to look for the first location.
- We understand the financial requirements.
- We know whether CHF 250,000 is realistic or needs to be adjusted.
- We know which customer segments matter most.
- We know how the product must be adapted.
- We know which partners and ambassadors to approach.
- We have a usable investor story.
- We have a concrete execution roadmap.
- We are ready to prepare the Jakarta trip and start serious discussions with local stakeholders.

11. Closing Thought

CORSA is entering this Capstone Project not as an idea, but as a young brand with proof of execution.

The Zurich pop-up showed that the product, brand and community logic can work. The next step is to translate this into an international flagship model.

Jakarta is not only a market opportunity. It is a test of whether CORSA can become what it is meant to become:

A global functional food and lifestyle brand built around movement, culture, performance and community.

The Capstone Project should help turn this ambition into a clear, calculated and executable plan.